

Cat Sundown Syndrome Guide — Action Checklist

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MEDICAL TESTING

- ☐ **Medical Testing:** Request a full senior blood panel including Total T4 thyroid test to rule out hyperthyroidism, which commonly causes loud nighttime vocalization in cats over 10 years old.
- ☐ **Medical Testing:** Ask your vet to measure your cat's blood pressure during the visit since hypertension is common in older cats and causes disorientation, head tilts, and crying out especially at night.
- ☐ **Medical Testing:** Request joint palpation for arthritis screening because most cats over 12 have arthritis and pain management can significantly reduce nighttime crying that happens when settling into painful positions.
- ☐ **Medical Testing:** Bring a detailed list of all behavior changes including appetite, litter box habits, grooming, sleeping locations, and navigation problems to help your vet identify medical causes beyond general aging.

NIGHTTIME HOME SAFETY

- ☐ **Nighttime Home Safety:** Place nightlights in hallways, near litter boxes, and around your cat's favorite sleeping spots to help a vision-impaired or disoriented cat navigate safely when the house is dark.
- ☐ **Nighttime Home Safety:** Keep food, water, and litter boxes easily accessible on a single floor level so your senior cat does not need to climb stairs or search for essentials during confused nighttime episodes.
- ☐ **Nighttime Home Safety:** Create a consistent safe zone with familiar bedding near your bed where your cat can rest during the night, reducing the disorientation that triggers yowling episodes.
- ☐ **Nighttime Home Safety:** Use baby gates to block access to stairs and dangerous areas where a confused senior cat might fall or become trapped while pacing and searching for orientation cues.

CAREGIVER SUPPORT

- ☐ **Caregiver Support:** Accept that caregiver exhaustion is real and valid, and recognize that feeling frustrated does not mean you love your cat any less during this difficult adjustment period.
 - ☐ **Caregiver Support:** Schedule brief daily breaks for yourself even if just 15 minutes of quiet time, because your mental and physical health directly affects your ability to care for your senior cat.
 - ☐ **Caregiver Support:** Research feline cognitive dysfunction support groups or online communities where other owners share practical strategies for managing nighttime yowling in senior cats.
 - ☐ **Caregiver Support:** Set realistic expectations by understanding that managing senior cat dementia is an ongoing process requiring patience, and small improvements in your cat's comfort are meaningful victories.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.